

NEWS ANALYSIS
On the Trail,
Trump’s Focus
Is Still Trump
As G.O.P. Struggles,
Air of a Farewell Tour

By KATIE ROGERS
If President Trump's earlier political rallies felt like standing-room-only rock concerts, the latest ones are starting to feel like the first stops of a farewell tour.
The events are a ritual. He will attack Democrats. His words will probably stop making actual, logical sense for a moment, or for many moments. (It's "the weave," you see.) He will accuse Democrats of rigging the 2020 election (they didn't). He will attack the news media. Then he will dance to a Village People song.

At a time when embattled Republican candidates could use concentrated attention — and money — to elevate a prospective new crop of leaders, Mr. Trump is clinging to an old strategy that has served him for years: talking mostly about himself. With a month until the midterms, he is again rallying, talking up his record, offering cash prizes and asking supporters to play pretend.
"I'm really in to win it. We want to win the midterms," Mr. Trump told a crowd at a high school student center in Vandalia, Ohio, on Saturday evening. "If you don't mind, please pretend that I'm on the ballot."

I have been covering Trump rallies, on and off, for almost a decade, including one held in the packed, 7,300-person-capacity gymnasium of my former middle school in Indiana. I have covered them as three-act plays, as formulaic festivals, and as laboratories for Mr. Trump to road-test misinformation, insult a Democratic opponent or gauge the bond he has forged with a potent slice of American voters.

Mr. Trump was in Oklahoma, Alabama and Ohio this past week for rallies, with a brief stop in Texas. On this last road tour, there are hints that he understands he has ground to make
Continued on Page A18

Donor Reaped
Deal for Planes
As Noem Exited

This article is by Hamed Aleaziz, David A. Fahrenthold, Nicholas Nehamas, Tyler Pager and Niraj Chokshi.

WASHINGTON — In the last hours of Kristi Noem's tenure as the homeland security secretary, her agency delivered a windfall to one of her political donors by buying five airplanes from the man's firm at a substantial markup, documents show.
The Department of Homeland Security agreed to pay the donor's firm \$108 million for a Boeing 737 airliner that had been converted into a massive private jet, complete with a stand-up bar, two bedrooms, marble showers and a table covered in manta ray skin.
The firm, Daedalus Aviation Corporation, had bought the same plane a few months earlier from a seller who had asked for less than \$90 million, according to documents reviewed by The New York Times.
At the same time, the agency agreed to buy two smaller Gulfstream luxury jets at prices that also seemed to yield a hefty profit for the seller. Daedalus spent about \$83 million to buy the pair, but resold them to the agency for \$106 million, the documents show.
Continued on Page A15

NATIONAL A13-21
Justices Tangle in Climate Case
The Supreme Court began its new term with a dispute pitting local governments against oil companies. PAGE A16
Amish Rethink Vaccines
A measles outbreak in Pennsylvania and Ohio changed some minds on the need for shots. PAGE A13



SILVIO AVILA/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE — GETTY IMAGES



LUCAS LANDAU/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Supporters of Flávio Bolsonaro, the right-wing candidate, top, and supporters of Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva, the left-wing incumbent, as ballots were counted for a presidential election on Sunday.

NEWS ANALYSIS
An Unexpected Wave for Brazil’s Right Wing

By ANA IONOVA and ADAM B. ELLICK
RIO DE JANEIRO — A surprise victory for a right-wing populist embroiled in scandal. Crushing defeat for a party deemed out of touch with its base. Supporters on the left grasping for answers.
The scene may feel familiar to Americans. This time, it unfolded in a Latin American nation thousands of miles away. And the results could profoundly reshape the region and its relations with Washington.
Brazil's right-wing challenger,

Runoff Could Confirm
Latin America Trend

Flávio Bolsonaro, didn't win the presidency in the election on Sunday, but he seemed well on his way to victory.
His surprisingly strong showing gives a significant boost to the ascendant right in Latin America, placing Brazil, the region's most populous country, within reach as the biggest electoral prize following seven wins by right-wing candidates.

It also represents a remarkable comeback for the Bolsonaro family, four years after Mr. Bolsonaro's father, Jair Bolsonaro, tried to subvert democracy after losing the last election, was convicted of plotting a coup and sentenced to prison.
Flávio Bolsonaro himself overcame being embroiled in a corruption scandal to win more votes than the leftist incumbent, President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva.
While neither clinched enough ballots to win in the first round of voting, Mr. Bolsonaro's formidable
Continued on Page A12



PAUL HOSEFROS/THE NEW YORK TIMES

DENNIS HASTERT, 1942-2026
An Illinois politician who became the longest-serving G.O.P. speaker of the House fell from grace after leaving government. In 2016, he admitted to abusing teenage boys decades earlier. Page A22.

INTERNATIONAL A4-12
Flying Dangerously
The Trump administration says all Iranian airlines are being "shut down." So why is a jet still traveling from Tehran to Southeast Asia? PAGE A4
Ramallah's Rivalry: Ice Cream
The competition between two popular shops in the West Bank inspires fierce loyalties, and a running joke, for lovers of cones piled high. PAGE A6
Nobel for Neuroscience
Three scientists were recognized for their work on light-gated ion channels and optogenetics, which uses pulses of light to activate brain neurons. PAGE A11

BUSINESS B1-7
Hollywood Mogul’s Challenges
David Ellison, the owner of a colossal media portfolio, now must make tough decisions about news, movies, sports, streaming and debt. PAGE B6
One Heedless Juggernaut
While rising borrowing costs take a toll, A.I. investment is full speed ahead, and contributing to inflation. PAGE B1

SPORTS B8-12
The N.H.L.’s Brash Brothers
Brady and Matthew Tkachuk, now together on the Florida Panthers, are welcoming a bigger spotlight. PAGE B8

ARTS C1-6
Recalling ‘Friday Night Lights’
The creator and stars of the acclaimed football drama recount how the show came together 20 years ago. PAGE C1
LL Cool J’s Next Assignment
The veteran rapper and actor reprises his longtime “NCIS: Los Angeles” role of Sam Hanna for a new spinoff. PAGE C1



SCIENCE TIMES D1-8
Answers in an \$80 Motel Room
A scrappy science project led to a big finding: two species of an organism that could shed light on life's origins. PAGE D8

An Unwieldy Arsenal
Targeted gene therapies are effective at stopping cancers, but the treatments' very abundance hinders access. PAGE D1

OPINION A24-25
Maia Szalavitz
PAGE A25



Superpowers Racing to Put
Nuclear Reactors on Moon

Experts Warn of Radioactive Risks From a
Rocket Mishap or Lunar Meltdown

By SELAM GEBREKIDAN
HONG KONG — In late August, NASA asked contractors to prepare to build a nuclear reactor that could survive a space voyage and run without maintenance near the moon's south pole. That may sound like science fiction, but the agency wants it ready to be launched by December 2030.
There is a reason for the rush. Russia aims to have a lunar reactor running by 2036 as part of a secretive partnership with China. NASA has already sped up its schedule to beat its rivals.
The race is for the very future of space exploration. The United States and China want to be first to establish a moon base, to search for resources like frozen water and to launch missions deeper into the solar system. Controlling access to the moon's assets is vital to this mission. Both superpowers believe a nuclear reactor is the centerpiece of this ambition.
The countries plan to turn on their reactors only after they reach the moon. But some leading scientists caution that governments are moving too quickly in an era of space exploration that has seen some notable disasters. In the last six years, multiple Chinese, American and Russian rockets have failed and exploded, and a Russian lander has crashed into the moon. Space junk regularly tumbles to Earth.
Failures could cause a chain reaction with dire consequences.
Falling reactor debris could scatter radioactive material, as happened in Canada in the late 1970s. An explosion or a meltdown on the moon's surface would risk turning entire regions into no-go zones.
"There will always be a space race going on, and if you enter nuclear power into that mix, then it could take a potentially more dangerous turn," said Edwin Lyman, the director of nuclear power safety at the Union of Concerned Scientists.
A review of technical specifications, procurement documents and academic research, along with interviews with industry insiders, government officials and critics, offers the clearest picture to date of how China, Russia and the United States are pursuing this nuclear ambition.
The records also help explain a key aspect of the Chinese-Russian space partnership, an alliance championed by Presidents Xi Jinping and Vladimir V. Putin.
Nuclear power appears to be the only core task that China has delegated to its partner in the lunar project. No country has more experience than Russia in this area. It launched more than 30 reactors into orbit, mostly in the 1970s and 1980s, aboard Cold War-era satellites, and it is a leader in civilian nuclear power. Russia controls the largest supply of what is considered the safest nuclear
Continued on Page A10

Cut Off From Rest of Ukraine,
And on the Brink of Starvation

This article is by Siobhán O’Grady, Liubov Sholudko and Yurii Shyvala.

KYIV, Ukraine — Little news trickles out from the besieged city of Oleshky, a frontline wasteland severed by mines and drones from the rest of Russian-occupied Ukraine.
But one thing is clear from what has emerged: A humanitarian calamity is unfolding. There is no food, no safety and no escape.
"In the autumn, we will definitely die," one resident wrote this summer. "I am already dying. I am getting weaker with each day."
"We're cooking our last borscht," wrote another, "with one beet, five potatoes, one onion, a
Continued on Page A9

People Plead for Aid in
Grim Russian Siege

zucchini, a tomato and a little barley groats to make it thicker. There are no carrots."
A third said: "There are no supplies of any kind. It's a complete blockade. And endless drones and fires. Like in a horror movie."
These messages, from some of the roughly 2,000 civilians, including about 40 children, who remain in Oleshky, were shared with The New York Times by Tetiana Hasanenko, the city's exiled leader. They offer a glimpse into the de-
Continued on Page A9

At Dog Park, Trading Words,
Then Gunshots, Over Trump

By JESSICA CONTRERA
BAINBRIDGE TOWNSHIP, Ohio — Before any criminal charges were filed, before any weapons were drawn, before anybody mentioned the president, a dog named Bob wanted to go to the park.
Bob's owner, David Mattai, had the week off from his job as a forklift mechanic. Mr. Mattai, 55, first tried taking Bob on a hiking trail, but the spaniel refused to walk. So Mr. Mattai drove to his favorite dog park in Bainbridge Township.
At a picnic table inside the park that April afternoon were Emmanuel Mathews, 80, and his corgi, Frankie.
Mr. Mathews was retired from a career as a meat distributor, and on the days when his back wasn't causing him problems he was a regular at the park.
He had brought a copy of The Wall Street Journal with headlines that included "Trump Grap-
ples With Fears on War."
The events that unfolded over the next 20 minutes — pieced together from interviews, records and body camera footage — would be unusual, but hardly unthinkable in a country where political
Continued on Page A14



DANIEL LOZADA FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

"This country is in a big divide," said a witness in Ohio.